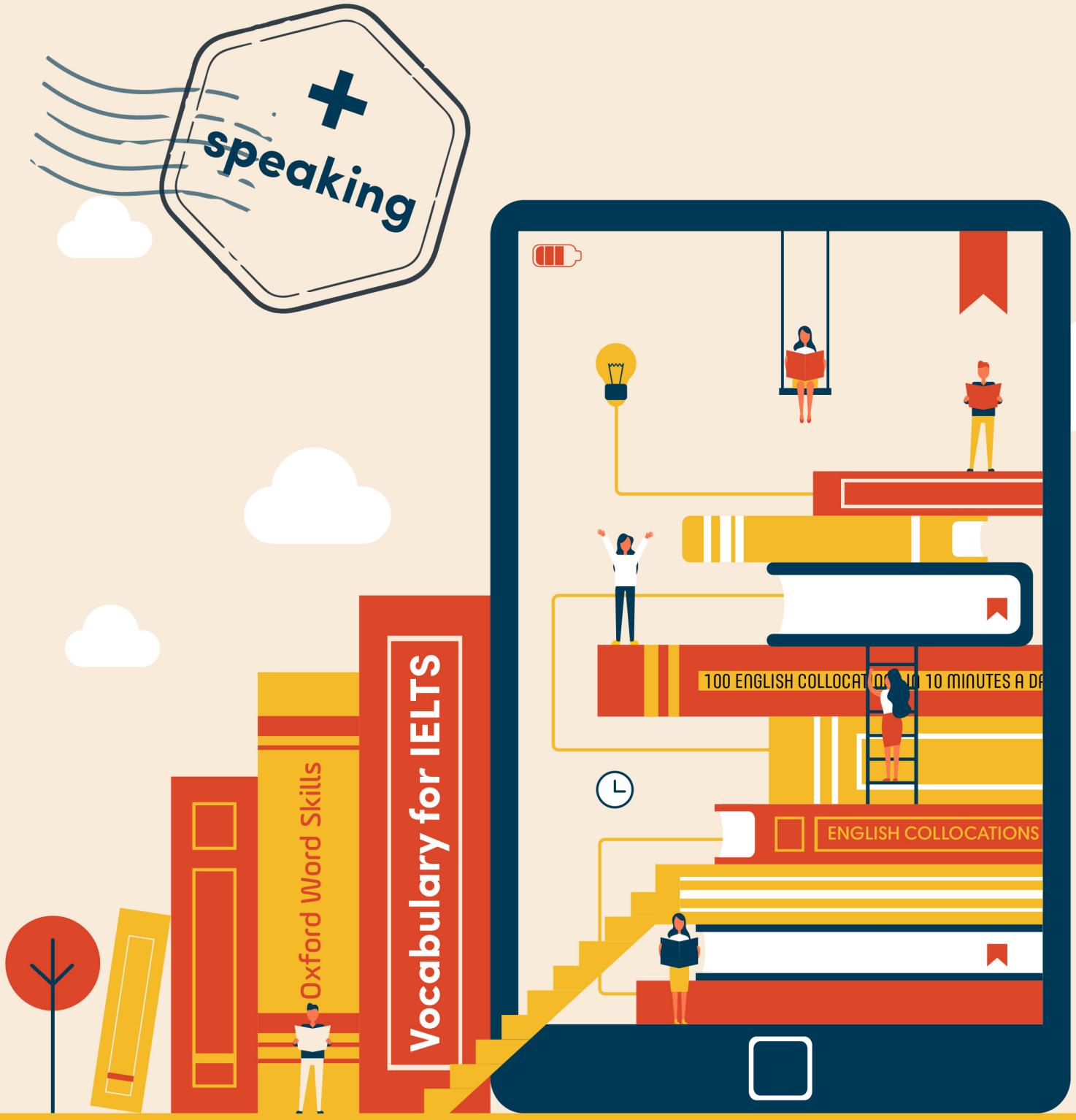
IELTS Up Words!

دوره لغات آیلتس

Yasaman Esmaeili

Yasi.esl



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Lesson 22: Buildings

Buildings

Hello again. I am back with another lesson of IELTS Up Words! In this lesson, we are going to talk about buildings and our homes. But what is a home really? Is it just a set of bricks? Or can it be something more?

They say, "Home is where the heart is," which means your home will always be the place for which you feel the deepest affection, no matter where you are. But what about homeless people? Don't they feel affection for a place in the world? Anyway, where is YOUR home? Today's question is about just that. So, listen to it and try your best, like always, to answer it. Remember the one-minute game that I talked about in the previous lesson? You could also play it with this question.

Describe your home.

I live on the sixth floor of a high-rise building, which is mostly made of concrete and glass. You can't find much timber in the design of this building, which is such a shame as I am a big fan of wooden homes. My place is a two-bedroom flat with a spacious kitchen, ventilated rooms, and large windows overlooking the lake nearby. This apartment has gone through some renovation, and these floor-to-ceiling windows were added as a result, and I think they are the best feature of my home. The only thing I don't like about this place is the bathroom because it is really cramped. I prefer an airy bathroom with a bathtub installed in it.

Speaking Tip

Idiomatic Language

Let me remind you of a few important points in terms of using idioms. As you know, an idiom is a group of words whose overall meaning is different from the meanings of the individual words. For example, “under the weather” is an idiom meaning “slightly ill.”

Now, did you know that it is important to use idioms in your speaking test? Yes, it is necessary to use a couple of idioms when you speak to improve your score. But remember to use them correctly and only when needed. Excessive use of idioms will damage your score and is not deemed natural.

Below is a list of idioms you can use in a variety of topics.



Idiom	Meaning	Example	Translation
off the top of my head	to say something spontaneously, without much thought or consideration as to whether one is correct	–How much was it? –Off the top of my head, I would say about $20.	تا جایی که حضور ذهن دارم؛ اولین چیزی که به ذهنم می‌رسد
to find your feet	to become familiar with and confident in a new situation	Moving to a new city was difficult, but I soon found my feet.	خو گرفتن با شرایط جدید؛ اعتمادبه‌نفس پیداکردن
open one's eyes to	to make someone see or realize the truth about something	The documentary really opened my eyes to the conditions in that country.	چشم کسی را به حقیقتِ چیزی باز کردن
on the fence	not able to decide something	She is still on the fence, trying to decide whether she will take the job.	دودل‌بودن؛ مردد بودن
a blessing in disguise	something that seems bad or unlucky at first, but results in something good happening later	Being caught in that traffic jam was a blessing in disguise. If I hadn't missed the flight, I would have been on that plane when it crashed.	چیزی که در ابتدا خوشایند نیست، اما سپس مشخص می‌شود که خوب بوده؛ بدون حکمت نبودن
see eye to eye with someone	to agree with someone, or to have the same opinion as them	I don't see eye to eye with my father on many things.	توافق‌نظر داشتن/تفاهم داشتن با کسی
to read between the lines	to try to understand someone's real feelings or intentions from what they say or write	Reading between the lines, I'd say he isn't happy with the situation.	معنی نهفتهٔ چیزی را دریافتن؛ دریافتن محتوای نهفته در کلام یا نوشته یا هر چیزی که صریح بیان نشده

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
a set of bricks	a row of bricks	یک ردیف آجر	
home is where the heart is	wherever you are and whoever you are with, your home and family provide the greatest emotional bond	خانه همان جاست که دل آنجا خوش است	there is no place like home
homeless people	people who have nowhere to live and who often live on the streets	افراد بی‌خانمان	synonym: the homeless homelessness
on the sixth floor	the sixth level in a building	در طبقهٔ ششم	on the top/first/ tenth floor
a high-rise building	a tall building with many floors	ساختمان مرتفع	synonym: a skyscraper opposite = a low-rise building
concrete	a substance used for building that is made by mixing sand, small stones, cement, and water	بتن	rough concrete; slabs of concrete
timber	pieces of wood used for building or making things	الوار	lumber (AmE) a bench made of timber; lumberjack
wooden homes	houses made of wood	خانه‌های چوبی	a wooden bench wooden toys
a two-bedroom flat	an apartment that has two bedrooms	آپارتمان دوخوابه	flat (BrE) = apartment (AmE) flat vs. apartment vs home vs. building

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
spacious kitchen	a kitchen with plenty of space to move around in	آشپزخانهٔ جادار	spaciously (adverb) spaciousness (noun)
ventilated rooms	rooms in which air enters and circulates freely	اتاق‌های دارای تهویهٔ مناسب	well-ventilated/ poorly ventilated ventilation (noun)
windows overlooking a lake	windows with a view of a lake	پنجره‌هایی با نمای رو به دریاچه	synonym: having a view of; affording a view
renovation	the act of repairing or improving a building to a better state	بازسازی	synonym: redecoration; restoration; modernization; home remodel
floor-to-ceiling windows	windows that are the full height of a wall	پنجره‌هایی از کف زمین تا سقف	floor-to-ceiling shelves/cupboards
cramped	limited in the freedom to move because there is not enough space	تنگ؛ درهم‌برهم	opposite = spacious a cramped room/ house
airy	with a lot of light and space	دلباز و نورگیر	airiness (noun)
bathtub	a long plastic, metal, or ceramic container that is filled with water so that you can sit or lie in it to wash your whole body	وان حمام	bath (BrE)

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
the deepest affection	a strong feeling of love and caring for someone	عشق عمیق	(in) one's affections (the feelings of love and caring that someone has)
such a shame	it is very unfortunate; not satisfactory	باعث تأسف است	synonym: what a shame; that is a shame
it is deemed natural	it is considered or judged to be natural	طبیعی پنداشته میشود	



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